

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 100

By Faison

A RESOLUTION relative to overdose reversal initiatives.

WHEREAS, this General Assembly recognizes and applauds the public and private overdose reversal initiatives currently in place; and

WHEREAS, this General Assembly acknowledges that the treatment of addiction is a complex policy issue that demands more resources across the board to create a more effective continuum of care; and

WHEREAS, in the interim, saving lives should be an urgent and top priority for the State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, this General Assembly recognizes that recent encouraging, but modest, decreases in the overdose death rate in Tennessee suggest that greater availability and awareness of overdose reversal medications, such as Narcan, could accelerate a decrease in the number of lives lost to overdose; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 9-4-1301, establishes the opioid abatement fund to support opioid abatement, treatment, and remediation programs and services from proceeds received from the statewide opioid settlement agreement entered into with various pharmaceutical companies and pharmacies, such proceeds to be disbursed at the direction of the Tennessee opioid abatement council; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 33-11-103, requires the Tennessee opioid abatement council to disburse thirty-five percent (35%) of these proceeds to counties that "join the settlement" in accordance with data measuring the impact of the opioid crisis at the county level; and

WHEREAS, the Tennessee opioid abatement council is further required to disburse the remaining sixty-five percent (65%) of such proceeds for statewide, regional, or local opioid abatement and remediation purposes through a competitive grant application process; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that this General Assembly respectfully urges the Tennessee opioid abatement council and each county that has joined the settlement to allocate a minimum of twenty-five percent (25%) of expenditures approved from the opioid abatement fund pursuant to Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 33-11-103, to specific initiatives that save lives via the distribution and promotion of overdose reversal medications until such time as the overdose death rate in Tennessee has been reduced by a minimum of twenty-five percent (25%).

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that a certified copy of this resolution be transmitted to the Tennessee opioid abatement council, which shall ensure that additional copies be distributed to each participating county.